

Copenhagen Summit: Enemies of the Earth

DECEMBER 21, 2009

How the US, EU, Japan, China and Australia among others have worked to derail the Copenhagen Summit on climate change, gravely threatening the future of our planet.



“A collective death wish would aptly express the attitude of nations, particularly the advanced ones. Containing emissions is a matter of presumptive need, whether the global jamborees succeed or not.”

BISHAN SAHAJ, via www.indiatoday.in

Heat and Dust

Although inauthentic and superstitious prophecies should not be believed, the vulpine cleverness and farcical articulation of enemies of the earth are bolstering the same (“Enemies of the Earth”, December 21). Industrialised nations are making convoluted arguments to scuttle the Kyoto Protocol with tokenistic announcements. India must accentuate and exhibit its determination to save the planet with critical evaluation of the minutiae, without affecting the growth and progress of the country.

INDU SHANKAR, *Varanasi*

It is appalling that the much-needed collective action to restrict global warming has been held hostage to the bickering



Politics of Security

As more and more politicians are found clamouring for it, security cover is now synonymous with status (“Security Farce”, December 21). Recently, the Home Ministry promised to review the security arrangements for VIPs who are not under any threat, but no action was taken to reduce their cover. The Government should revise the policy so that all except the prime minister, governors and chief ministers should be asked to foot the bill for their security. Then those who do not require it will automatically surrender the same.

R. MURALIKUMAR, *Chennai*

Who needs security in this country? Not the commoner by whom the rulers swear. Nobody seems to be bothered about the life of the ordinary man on the street, while the politicians with criminal charges against them are provided with extra security.

A. SRIKANTIAH, *Bangalore*

and the clash of egos between the developed and developing nations. Though it is commendable that India, China, Brazil and the African countries haven't buckled under pressure from the Umbrella Group to commit themselves to legally binding cuts in greenhouse gases, it is equally important for India to be sincere by striving to wean away from its dependence on fossil fuels and promoting alternative sources of energy.

NALINI VIJAYARAGHAVAN,
Thiruvananthapuram

Inflationary Times

The rising prices of essential commodities besides hikes in bus and metro fares, electricity and now water tariffs prove that the economic policies of the Government are

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